TCS NQT 2027 · VERBAL ABILITY · COMPLETE MASTERY GUIDE (2027 PATTERN)

Verbal Ability Complete Mastery

Beginner to advanced: grammar, vocabulary and the three new-pattern tasks (sentence completion, passage recall, email writing), with diagrams, rules, solved examples, templates and practice.

16	74	139	22
chapters, basic to advanced	solved examples	practice and test questions	diagrams and charts

ONLINE LEARNING MOCK TEST SERIES · ATC DEVELOPERS

About this guide

The new Verbal Ability section has three timed tasks: **Sentence Completion** (20 items, about 25 seconds each), **Passage Recall** (4 tasks, 30 seconds to read and 90 seconds to type) and **Email Writing** (about 9 minutes). This guide teaches the grammar and vocabulary behind the first task from zero, then trains the memory and writing skills for the other two.

How each chapter is built

- **Idea:** the topic in plain words.
- **Diagram:** a picture of the method.
- **Rules box:** the yellow box to revise.
- **Solved examples** with the reason for the answer.
- **Shortcuts and mistakes.**
- **Practice set** (Basic, Medium, Advanced) with answers at the end.

How to study

- Chapters 1–12: one or two a day; redo the examples without looking.
- Chapter 13: timed drills at 25 seconds per item.
- Chapter 14: practise recall with a timer and score the key facts.
- Chapter 15: write one email a day from the templates.
- Chapter 16: take the mini test and follow the five-week plan.

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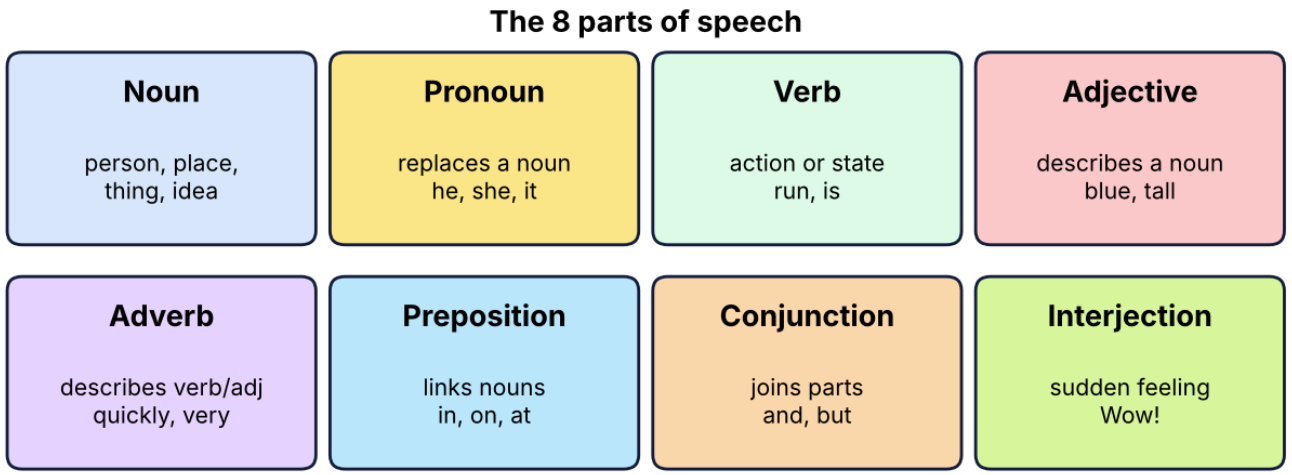
Honest note

- Grammar and vocabulary answers were written and double-checked by hand; they were not machine-verified. Where usage differs between books, the guide gives the form most exam setters use.
- In the recall chapter every key fact was checked by code to be present in its passage and in the model recall; email body lengths were counted by code.
- The marking rules for recall and email in the real test are not public; the self-scores here are practice tools only.

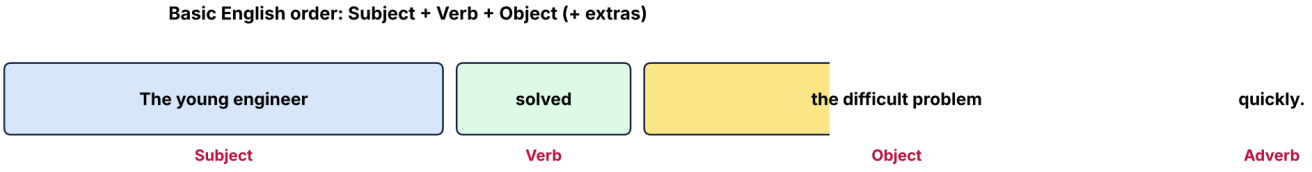
VERBAL ABILITY · FOUNDATION · START HERE

01 Parts of Speech and Sentence Basics

Every sentence-completion question is built from a few simple parts. Before you learn tenses and agreement, be sure you can **name each word's job**. Once you can say "this blank needs a verb" or "this blank needs an adjective", wrong options vanish quickly.



Eight parts of speech. A word can change its job with its place in the sentence: "light" is a noun in "turn on the light", an adjective in "a light bag" and a verb in "light a lamp".



A sentence has a subject (who or what), a verb (what happens) and often an object (who or what receives the action).

Basic rules

- A complete sentence needs **a subject and a finite verb** and must express a complete thought.
- **Noun** forms: singular/plural (child–children), countable/uncountable (bottle/water), common/proper (city/Mumbai).
- **Adjective** goes before a noun (a quick reply) or after a linking verb (the reply was quick).
- **Adverb** answers how, when, where or how much (replied quickly, arrived late, very tall).
- **Preposition** is followed by a noun or pronoun (in the office, with him), and by the **-ing form** of a verb (good at singing).
- **Conjunctions**: coordinating (FANBOYS: for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so), subordinating (because, although, if, when, while).
- Transitive verbs need an object (she reads books); intransitive verbs do not (she sleeps).

Word-ending hint	Usually a	Examples
-tion, -ment, -ness, -ity, -ance	noun	action, payment, kindness, ability
-ful, -ous, -able, -ive, -al	adjective	careful, famous, readable, active

-ly (added to adjective)	adverb	quickly, carefully
-ize, -ify, -en, -ate	verb	organize, simplify, widen, create

Choose the word that fits: Her ___ to the project was appreciated. (a) contribute (b) contribution (c) contributing (d) contributory

(b) contribution

The blank follows “Her” and is the subject, so a noun is needed: contribution. Suffix -tion marks a noun.

Choose the word that fits: He answered the question ___. (a) correct (b) correctness (c) correctly (d) correcting

(c) correctly

A word is needed to describe how he answered, so an adverb: correctly.

Identify the part of speech of “fast” in: He is a fast learner.

Adjective

“Fast” describes the noun “learner”.

Shortcuts and tricks

- Look at the word before and after the blank; it decides the part of speech.
- A blank after an article (a/an/the) or an adjective is usually a noun.
- A blank after “is / was / are” can be an adjective or a verb in -ing/-ed.
- A blank before an adjective is usually an adverb (very, quite, extremely).

Common mistakes

- Using an adjective where an adverb is needed (“he runs quick”).
- Using a noun where an adjective is needed (“a success plan” instead of “a successful plan”).
- Using a verb after a preposition without -ing (“interested in learn”).

Practice set: Foundation practice

1. She sings ___. (a) beautiful (b) beautifully (c) beauty (d) beautify — Basic
2. He is interested in ___ new languages. (a) learn (b) learned (c) learning (d) learns — Basic
3. The ___ of the new road reduced traffic. (a) complete (b) completion (c) completely (d) completing — Medium
4. This is a very ___ problem. (a) seriously (b) serious (c) seriousness (d) seriousy — Medium
5. Which word is an adverb? (a) quick (b) quickly (c) quickness (d) quicken — Medium
6. Choose the correct sentence. (a) He is good in maths. (b) He is good at maths. (c) He is good on maths. (d) He is good with maths. — Advanced
7. The manager gave us a ___ explanation. (a) clear (b) clearly (c) clarity (d) clarify — Advanced

02 VERBAL ABILITY · GRAMMAR · MUST-DO
Tenses

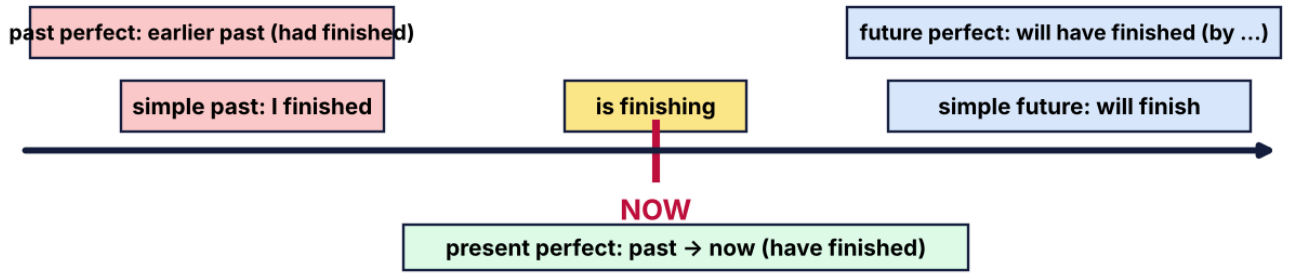
A tense tells **when** an action happens and whether it is **finished or still going**. It is the most common blank in sentence completion. Learn the twelve forms as a table and learn the **signal words** that point to each one.

The 12 tenses at a glance

Form	PAST	PRESENT	FUTURE
Simple	I worked	I work	I will work
Continuous	I was working	I am working	I will be working
Perfect	I had worked	I have worked	I will have worked
Perfect continuous	I had been working	I have been working	I will have been working

Every tense is a combination of time (past, present, future) and type (simple, continuous, perfect, perfect continuous).

Tenses on a timeline



Where each tense sits relative to “now”.

Tense	Use	Signal words	Example
Simple present	habit, fact, schedule	always, every day, usually, never	She goes to office by metro.
Present continuous	happening now / planned soon	now, at the moment, today, currently	They are waiting outside.
Present perfect	past action with present result	since, for, already, yet, just, ever, so far	I have finished the report.
Present perfect continuous	action started in past and still going	since, for, how long, lately	He has been working since 9 a.m.
Simple past	finished action at a known time	yesterday, ago, last week, in 2019	We met last Monday.
Past continuous	action in progress at a past moment	while, when, at that time	I was sleeping when you called.
Past perfect	earlier of two past actions	before, after, by the time, already	The train had left when we arrived.
Simple future	decision, prediction	tomorrow, soon, next week	I will call you.

Future perfect	finished before a future time	by next month, by then	By June she will have graduated.

Rules to remember

- **since** + point of time (since 2020); **for** + period (for five years). Both go with **present perfect** (not simple past).
- After **if / when / before / after / as soon as / unless / until** referring to the future, use the **present** tense, not "will": "If it rains, we will stay."
- **By the time** + simple past, main clause in past perfect: "By the time we arrived, the show had started."
- **Just now / ago / yesterday / last year** → simple past (never present perfect).
- Stative verbs (know, like, want, believe, own, belong) are normally **not** used in continuous forms.
- **Reported speech**: tense moves one step back (is → was, has done → had done). Universal truths stay in simple present.
- Sequence of tenses: keep the tense consistent in one narrative unless the time really changes.

He ___ in this company since 2018. (a) works (b) worked (c) has worked (d) is working

(c) has worked

"Since 2018" links the past to the present, so present perfect.

By the time the manager arrived, the meeting ___. (a) ended (b) has ended (c) had ended (d) was ending

(c) had ended

Two past events: the meeting ended earlier, so past perfect.

If she ___ hard, she will pass the exam. (a) will work (b) works (c) worked (d) would work

(b) works

After "if" in a future condition use the simple present.

I ___ him yesterday. (a) have met (b) met (c) had met (d) meet

(b) met

"Yesterday" fixes a finished time: simple past.

The teacher said that the earth ___ round the sun. (a) moved (b) moves (c) had moved (d) was moving

(b) moves

A universal truth stays in the simple present even in reported speech.

Shortcuts and tricks

- Underline the time word first; it decides the tense in about 80% of questions.
- Two past events: earlier = past perfect, later = simple past.
- “Since / for / already / yet / just / ever” → present perfect.
- “Yesterday / ago / last / in 2015” → simple past.
- After “wish” use a past form: “I wish I knew the answer.”

Common mistakes

- Simple past with “since” or “for” (“I lived here since 2019”).
- “Will” inside an if-clause (“If it will rain”).
- Present perfect with a finished time word (“I have seen him yesterday”).
- Continuous with stative verbs (“I am knowing him”).

Practice set: Tenses practice

1. She ___ to school every day. (a) go (b) goes (c) is going (d) went — Basic

2. They ___ a movie now. (a) watch (b) watched (c) are watching (d) have watched — Basic

3. I ___ my homework two hours ago. (a) finish (b) have finished (c) finished (d) was finishing — Basic

4. We ___ here for ten years. (a) live (b) lived (c) have lived (d) are living — Medium

5. When I reached the station, the train ___. (a) left (b) has left (c) had left (d) was leaving — Medium

6. Unless you ___ harder, you will fail. (a) work (b) will work (c) worked (d) are working — Medium

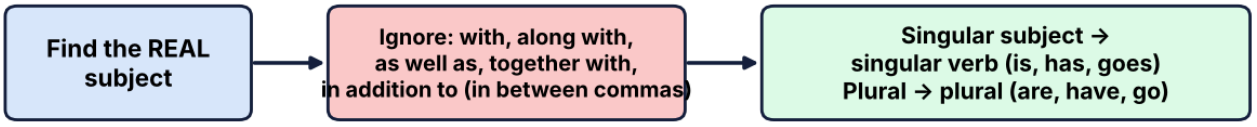
7. I wish I ___ more time yesterday. (a) have (b) had (c) had had (d) would have — Advanced

8. By next March, he ___ here for fifteen years. (a) works (b) will work (c) will have worked (d) has worked — Advanced

03 VERBAL ABILITY · GRAMMAR · MUST-DO
Subject–Verb Agreement

A verb must agree with its **subject** in number. The trick is to find the real subject, because the exam puts extra words between the subject and the verb to confuse you.

Subject–verb agreement in three moves



Example: "The manager, along with his team, IS attending." (subject = manager, singular)

Example: "One of the books IS missing." (subject = one, singular)

Three moves for every agreement question.

The agreement rules

- **Each, every, either, neither, one of, none of** + singular verb: "Each of the boys has a pen."
- **Along with, together with, as well as, in addition to**: verb agrees with the **first** subject: "The CEO, along with his staff, is present."
- **Either … or / neither … nor / not only … but also**: verb agrees with the **nearer** subject: "Neither the manager nor the employees are ready."
- **And** joins two subjects → plural: "Rama and Sita are friends." Exception: one idea or one person: "Bread and butter is my breakfast."
- Collective nouns (team, committee, family, jury) → singular when acting as one group, plural when members act separately.
- Uncountable nouns (information, advice, furniture, news, luggage, equipment, knowledge) are **singular**: "The news is good."
- Plural-looking singular words: **mathematics, physics, economics, news, series, measles** → singular. **Scissors, trousers, glasses, jeans** → plural.
- A phrase of measure (money, time, distance) → singular: "Ten kilometres is a long way."
- **The number of** + plural noun → singular verb; **A number of** + plural noun → plural verb.
- **There is / There are**: the verb agrees with the noun that follows.
- Relative clause: "He is one of those who are late." (verb agrees with "those").

Neither of the answers ___ correct. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) be

(b) is

"Neither of" takes a singular verb.

The manager, along with his team, ___ attending the meeting. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) have been

(b) is

Real subject is “manager”; “along with his team” is ignored.

A number of students ___ absent today. (a) is (b) was (c) are (d) has been

(c) are

“A number of” + plural noun gives a plural verb.

The number of unemployed graduates ___ rising. (a) are (b) have been (c) is (d) were

(c) is

“The number of” is singular (it refers to the count).

Either the teacher or the students ___ responsible. (a) is (b) are (c) was (d) has been

(b) are

Verb agrees with the nearer subject “students”.

Shortcuts and tricks

- Cross out everything between commas or inside “of ...” phrases and read the sentence again.
- Singular words that look plural: news, economics, mathematics.
- For “either ... or”, look at the word nearest the verb.
- “Many a” takes a singular verb: “Many a man has tried.”

Common mistakes

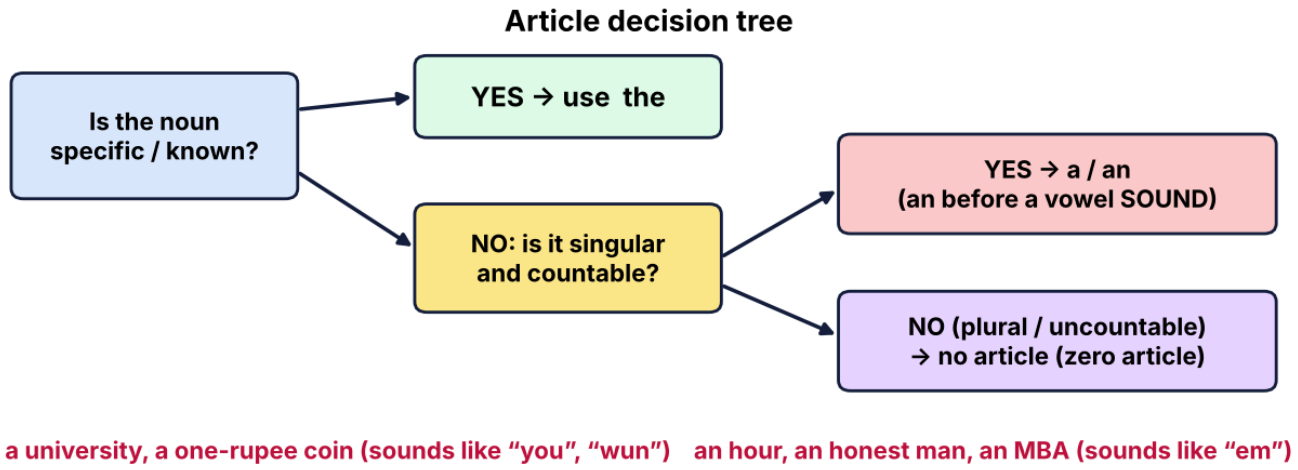
- Agreeing the verb with the nearest noun instead of the real subject (“The box of apples are fresh”).
- Treating “news” and “information” as plural.
- Using plural after “each / every”.

Practice set: Agreement practice

1. Each of the players ___ a medal. (a) have received (b) has received (c) are receiving (d) were receive — Basic
2. The news ___ true. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) have been — Basic
3. Neither the captain nor the players ___ ready. (a) is (b) was (c) are (d) has — Medium
4. The team ___ practising together. (a) is (b) are (c) were (d) be — Medium
5. Mathematics ___ my favourite subject. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) have been — Medium
6. The quality of these mangoes ___ poor. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) have been — Advanced
7. One of the boys who ___ late was punished. (a) was (b) is (c) were (d) has been — Advanced

04 VERBAL ABILITY · GRAMMAR · IMPORTANT
Articles and Determiners

Articles (**a, an, the**) and determiners (some, any, much, many, few, little, this, those) show **which noun** or **how many**. Questions test sound-based "a/an", the use of "the" with unique things, and the difference between few/a few and little/a little.



Follow the tree from the top. The sound, not the spelling, decides a or an.

Rules

- **a / an**: first mention, one of many. **an** before a vowel *sound* (an hour, an umbrella); **a** before a consonant sound (a university, a European).
- **the**: a noun already known, unique (the sun, the moon, the Earth), a superlative (the best), an ordinal (the first), rivers, oceans, mountain ranges (the Ganga, the Himalayas), newspapers (The Hindu), some countries (the USA, the UK).
- **No article**: plural/uncountable nouns used generally (Dogs are loyal; Water is essential), most countries and cities (India, Pune), languages, subjects (Maths), meals (have lunch), most sports.
- **Few / a few** (countable): few = almost none (negative); a few = some (positive). **Little / a little** (uncountable): same idea.
- **Much** + uncountable; **many** + countable. **Fewer** + countable; **less** + uncountable.
- **Some** in positive sentences and offers; **any** in negatives and questions.
- **Each / every / either / neither** + singular noun; **both / few / many** + plural noun.
- Fixed phrases: **in the morning, on the whole, by the way, at the moment**; **by bus, at home, in bed, at school** (no article).

She is ___ honest girl. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) no article

(b) an

"Honest" begins with a silent h; the sound is a vowel sound.

He bought ___ umbrella and ___ bag. ___ umbrella was red. (a) an, a, The (b) a, an, An (c) an, the, A (d) the, a, An

(a) an, a, The

First mention: an umbrella, a bag; second mention: The umbrella.

There is ___ water left in the bottle. We can hardly drink. (a) few (b) a few (c) little (d) a little

(c) little

Water is uncountable; "hardly" makes the sense negative, so "little".

The Ganga is ___ longest river in India. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) no article

(c) the

Superlative takes "the".

"There are ___ students in the class this year." (a) less (b) fewer (c) much (d) little

(b) fewer

Students are countable.

Shortcuts and tricks

- Say the word aloud: a unit, an hour, an MBA, a one-way street.
- Superlative or ordinal in the blank → "the".
- "few" and "little" are negative; add "a" to make them positive.
- Plural and uncountable nouns used in general statements take no article.

Common mistakes

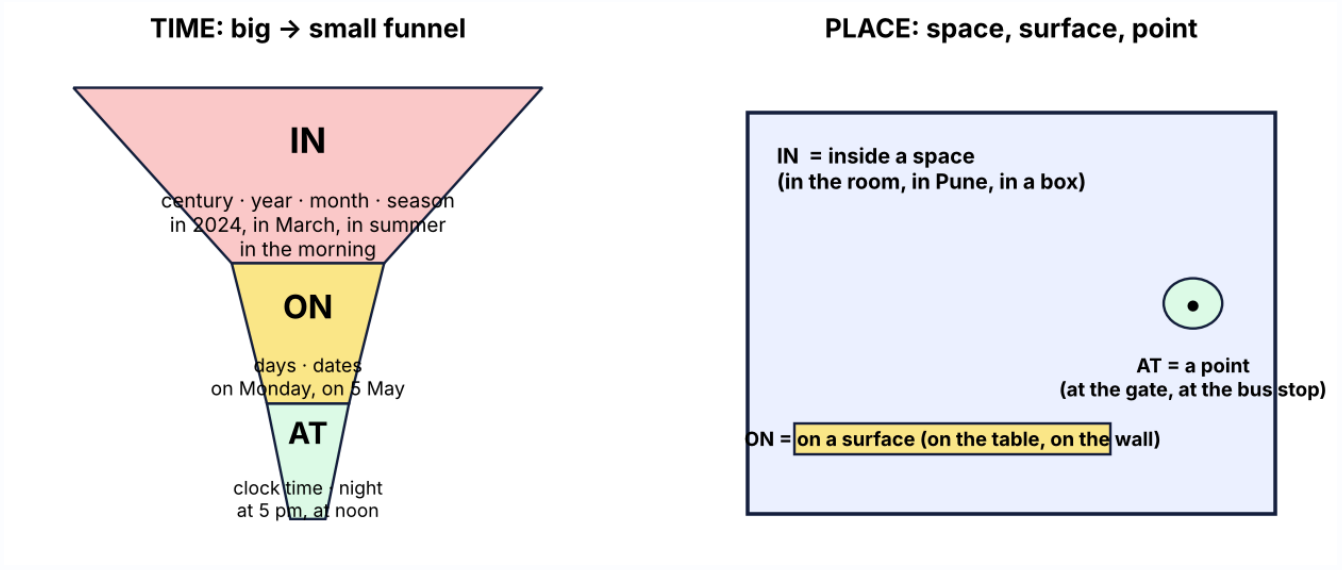
- "an university" (sound is "you").
- "the" before a general plural ("The dogs are loyal" as a general fact).
- "less" with countable nouns.

Practice set: Article practice

1.	He is ___ European. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) no article	Basic
2.	I met ___ old man yesterday. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) no article	Basic
3.	___ Sun rises in the east. (a) A (b) An (c) The (d) No article	Basic
4.	We have ___ time to finish. (a) few (b) a few (c) little (d) many	Medium
5.	He plays ___ cricket every evening. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) no article	Medium
6.	She was ___ only candidate selected. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) no article	Medium
7.	There are ___ people in the hall than yesterday. (a) less (b) fewer (c) much (d) little	Advanced
8.	He has ___ few friends, so he feels lonely. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) —	Advanced

05 VERBAL ABILITY · GRAMMAR · IMPORTANT
Prepositions

Prepositions are small words with a big share of marks. There is no logic behind many of them, so the strategy is to learn **the time and place rules** and then **memorise the common dependent prepositions** (adjective + preposition, verb + preposition).



The in-on-at funnel for time and the space-surface-point idea for place.

Adjective + preposition	Verb + preposition	Noun + preposition
good at, bad at, weak in	depend on, rely on, insist on	reason for, need for
afraid of, fond of, proud of, capable of	look for (search), look after (care), look into (investigate)	cause of, solution to, answer to
angry with (person), angry at (thing)	agree with (person), agree to (proposal), agree on (matter)	interest in, increase in, demand for
famous for, responsible for, eligible for	apologise to (person) for (action)	difference between, relation between
married to, similar to, superior to, senior to	prevent … from, protect … from	access to, attitude towards

Rules

- **since** + point of time, **for** + period of time.
- **between** two things, **among** more than two.
- **beside** = next to; **besides** = in addition to.
- **in / within**: "within a week" = before a week ends; "in a week" = after a week.
- **by** = not later than (by Friday) or the agent (written by him); **until / till** = up to a time.
- **on** a bus / train / plane / bike; **in** a car / taxi.
- After a preposition use a noun, pronoun or **-ing form**: "She is good at dancing."
- Prepositions are not used before: tomorrow, yesterday, today, last, next, this (e.g., "next week", not "on next week").

He has been working here ___ 2019. (a) for (b) from (c) since (d) in

(c) since

2019 is a point of time.

She is very fond ___ music. (a) with (b) of (c) at (d) on

(b) of

Fixed phrase: fond of.

The prize was divided ___ the three winners. (a) between (b) among (c) in (d) with

(b) among

More than two persons: among.

The report must be submitted ___ Friday at the latest. (a) in (b) at (c) by (d) since

(c) by

"By" marks a deadline: not later than Friday.

The meeting starts ___ 10 a.m. ___ Monday. (a) in, on (b) at, on (c) at, in (d) on, at

(b) at, on

Clock time: at; day: on.

Shortcuts and tricks

- Learn adjectives with their preposition as a pair: fond of, good at, afraid of.
- For time: in (big), on (day), at (clock).
- For travel: on a bus, in a car.
- When two prepositions fit, choose the one used with the main word (collocation), not the one that "sounds" right.

Common mistakes

- "depend from", "discuss about", "enter into the room", "married with": all wrong.
- Using "among" for two persons.
- Using "since" with a period ("since two years").

Practice set: Preposition practice

1. She is afraid ___ dogs. (a) from (b) of (c) with (d) to — Basic
2. He was born ___ 5 May. (a) in (b) at (c) on (d) by — Basic
3. The book is ___ the table. (a) in (b) on (c) at (d) by — Basic
4. He insisted ___ paying the bill. (a) at (b) on (c) for (d) to — Medium
5. We discussed ___ the project. (a) about (b) on (c) —(no preposition) (d) of — Medium
6. The company is responsible ___ the damage. (a) to (b) for (c) of (d) on — Medium

7. He apologised ___ me ___ his mistake. (a) to / for (b) for / to (c) with / on (d) at / of — Advanced

8. The result will be declared ___ a week. (a) in (b) within (c) on (d) since — Advanced

06 VERBAL ABILITY · GRAMMAR · IMPORTANT
Pronouns and Conjunctions

A **pronoun** replaces a noun; a **conjunction** joins words or clauses. Pronoun questions test case (I/me), agreement and reflexives. Conjunction questions test the **logical link** between two ideas: addition, contrast, reason, result.

Pronoun table (learn by heart)

Subject	Object	Possessive adj.	Possessive pron.	Reflexive
I	me	my	mine	myself
you	you	your	yours	yourself
he	him	his	his	himself
she	her	her	hers	herself
it	it	its	—	itself
we	us	our	ours	ourselves
they	them	their	theirs	themselves
who	whom	whose	—	—

The full pronoun table. Subject form comes before the verb, object form after a verb or preposition.

Pronoun rules

- After a preposition use the **object** form: between you and me (not “between you and I”), with him.
- After **than / as**, finish the sentence mentally: “She is taller than I (am).”
- **Who** = subject (who did it), **whom** = object (to whom, whom did you see). **Whose** = possession.
- **Reflexive** (myself …) is used when subject and object are the same or for emphasis: “She hurt herself.” Do not use it as a subject.
- A pronoun must agree with its noun in number and person: “Each student must bring his or her ID card.”
- **One** … **one’s**; **everyone / someone / nobody** → singular pronoun (he or she / they as a common form).
- **Its** (possessive, no apostrophe) vs **it’s** (it is / it has).
- Relative pronouns: **who** (people), **which** (things), **that** (people or things, restrictive), **whose** (possession).

Connectors by meaning: choose by logic, not by sound

Addition	Contrast	Reason
and, also, moreover, furthermore	but, however, although, yet, whereas, despite	because, since, as, owing to

Result	Condition	Time
so, therefore, hence, thus, consequently	if, unless, provided, in case	when, while, before, after, until

Choose the connector by the relationship between the two ideas.

Conjunction rules

- **Although / though / even though** + clause (no "but" in the same sentence): "Although he was tired, he finished the work."
- **Despite / in spite of** + noun or -ing (not a full clause): "Despite the rain, ..."
- **Because** + clause; **because of / due to / owing to** + noun.
- **Unless** = if not (do not use "not" after unless).
- **Not only ... but also**, **both ... and**, **either ... or**, **neither ... nor** must be followed by the same grammatical form (parallel).
- **Hardly / scarcely ... when**, **no sooner ... than**: "No sooner had he arrived than it rained."
- **Lest** + should: "Work hard lest you should fail."
- **While** can show time or contrast; **whereas** shows contrast.

She is taller than ___. (a) I (b) me (c) myself (d) mine

(a) I

"Than I am": subject form after than.

The decision was taken between my manager and ___. (a) I (b) me (c) myself (d) mine

(b) me

After a preposition: object form.

___ it was raining, the match continued. (a) Because (b) Although (c) Unless (d) So

(b) Although

The match continuing is a contrast to the rain.

He was tired ___ he went to bed early. (a) but (b) so (c) although (d) unless

(b) so

Result: tired, therefore went to bed.

You will not succeed ___ you work hard. (a) if (b) unless (c) although (d) until

(b) unless

Unless = if not.

Shortcuts and tricks

- Test a pronoun by removing the other person: “between you and (I/me)” → “between me”.
- If the two ideas are opposite, choose a contrast word; if one causes the other, choose a reason/result word.
- Do not use two connectors for one idea (“Although ... but ...” is wrong).
- Read the sentence with your option; if the logic breaks, reject it.

Common mistakes

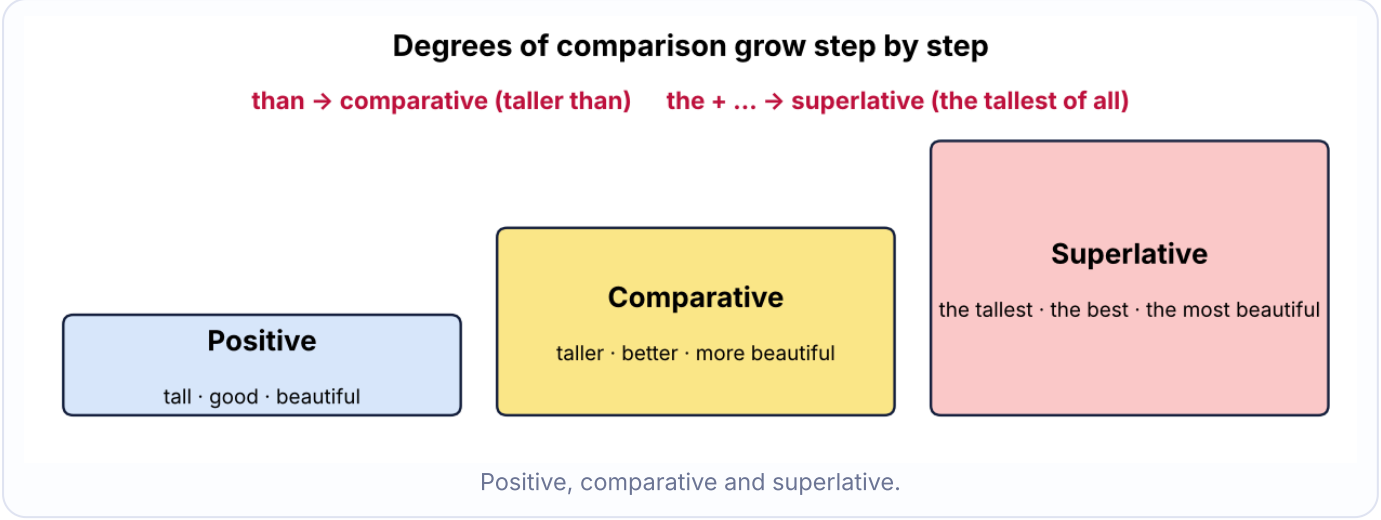
- “Between you and I”, “for him and I”.
- “Despite of”, “inspite”.
- “Because of” followed by a clause.
- Using “myself” as a subject (“Myself and Raj went”).

Practice set: Pronoun and conjunction practice

1.	She and ___ went to the market. (a) me (b) I (c) myself (d) mine	Basic
2.	This book is ___. (a) my (b) me (c) mine (d) myself	Basic
3.	___ he was ill, he came to work. (a) Because (b) Although (c) Unless (d) So	Basic
4.	The man ___ car was stolen filed a complaint. (a) who (b) whom (c) whose (d) which	Medium
5.	He failed ___ he did not study. (a) although (b) because (c) unless (d) but	Medium
6.	___ the heavy traffic, we reached on time. (a) Although (b) Despite (c) Because (d) Unless	Medium
7.	No sooner had she entered ___ the lights went off. (a) when (b) than (c) then (d) that	Advanced
8.	The cat licked ___ paws. (a) it’s (b) its (c) their (d) his	Advanced

07 VERBAL ABILITY · GRAMMAR · IMPORTANT
Adjectives, Adverbs and Comparison

Adjectives describe nouns; adverbs describe verbs, adjectives or other adverbs. Comparison questions test the correct degree (good–better–best), the word **than**, and double comparatives.



Positive, comparative and superlative.

Positive	Comparative	Superlative	Rule
tall	taller	tallest	one syllable: add -er / -est
happy	happier	happiest	y → i + er / est
beautiful	more beautiful	most beautiful	long words: more / most
good	better	best	irregular
bad	worse	worst	irregular
far	farther / further	farthest / furthest	distance / extra
old	older / elder	oldest / eldest	elder, eldest only for family
little	less	least	irregular
much / many	more	most	irregular

Rules

- Use **than** with the comparative, never “then” or “from”. Exceptions: **senior to, junior to, superior to, inferior to, prefer ... to** use “to”.
- No double comparatives or superlatives: “more better”, “most unkindest” are wrong.
- The superlative takes “the” and is used with three or more things: “the tallest of the three”.
- Adverbs of manner usually end in -ly; **good → well, fast → fast, hard → hard (hardly means almost not)**.
- Adjective order: opinion → size → age → shape → colour → origin → material: “a beautiful small old round red Indian wooden box”.
- **Enough** goes after an adjective (tall enough) and before a noun (enough money).
- **Very** + positive (very good); **much** + comparative (much better); **too** = more than needed (too hot to drink).
- Latin comparatives (senior, junior, superior, inferior, prior, anterior) take **to**.
- Absolute adjectives are not compared: unique, perfect, complete, round, empty, dead.

This is the ___ book I have ever read. (a) good (b) better (c) best (d) more good

(c) best

“the ... ever” needs a superlative; good → best.

He is senior ___ me. (a) than (b) to (c) from (d) of

(b) to

Senior takes “to”.

She works ___ than her sister. (a) hard (b) harder (c) hardest (d) hardly

(b) harder

“than” needs a comparative.

He is ___ to carry the box. (a) enough strong (b) strong enough (c) too strong (d) so strong

(b) strong enough

Enough follows the adjective.

Shortcuts and tricks

- Look for “than” (comparative) or “the ... of / in” (superlative) before choosing.
- Never double: “more better” is wrong.
- “to” after senior / junior / superior / inferior / prefer.
- If the adjective is long (three syllables or more), use more / most.

Common mistakes

- “more better”, “most easiest”.
- “He is more taller than me.”
- “He is elder than me” (use “older than” unless family relation; “elder to” is wrong).

Practice set: Comparison practice

1. She is ___ than her brother. (a) clever (b) cleverer (c) cleverest (d) most clever — Basic
2. Mount Everest is the ___ mountain in the world. (a) high (b) higher (c) highest (d) more high — Basic
3. This laptop is ___ expensive than that one. (a) much (b) most (c) more (d) many — Basic
4. He prefers tea ___ coffee. (a) than (b) to (c) from (d) over — Medium
5. The patient is getting ___ day by day. (a) good (b) better (c) best (d) well — Medium
6. Of the two sisters, Neha is the ___. (a) smarter (b) smartest (c) more smarter (d) most smart — Medium
7. He is junior ___ me by two years. (a) than (b) from (c) to (d) of — Advanced
8. The soup is ___ hot to drink. (a) very (b) too (c) much (d) enough — Advanced

VERBAL ABILITY · GRAMMAR · IMPORTANT

08 Modals, Conditionals and Wishes

Modal verbs (can, may, must, should) show ability, permission, duty and possibility. Conditionals link a condition to a result. Both appear often in sentence completion because each pattern has a **fixed shape**.

The four conditionals

Type	If-clause	Main clause	Example	Meaning
Zero	if + present	present	If you heat ice, it melts.	general truth
First	if + present	will + verb	If it rains, we will stay.	real future
Second	if + past	would + verb	If I were you, I would apply.	unreal present
Third	if + past perfect	would have + V3	If he had left, he would have caught it.	unreal past

Match the if-clause tense to the main clause tense.

Modal	Meaning	Example
can / could	ability, possibility	She can swim. Could you help me?
may / might	permission, possibility	May I come in? It might rain.
must	strong necessity / strong deduction	You must wear a helmet. He must be at home.
should / ought to	advice, duty	You should sleep early.
have to	external obligation	I have to submit it today.
used to	past habit	She used to play chess.
would	polite request, past habit	Would you wait? He would visit every Sunday.
need not	no necessity	You need not come.

Rules

- After a modal use the **base verb** (no -s, no to, no -ing): “She can sing.”
- **If I were** (not “was”) in unreal present conditions: “If I were you, ...”.
- **Had + subject + V3** can replace “if”: “Had I known, I would have come.”
- **Should + subject + V1** can replace “if”: “Should you need help, call me.”
- **I wish + past** (present regret); **I wish + had + V3** (past regret): “I wish I had studied.”
- **Would rather + V1** (I would rather stay); **would rather + subject + past** (I would rather you stayed).
- **Used to + V1** (past habit); **be used to + V-ing** (accustomed): “I am used to waking early.”
- **Had better + V1** = advice: “You had better leave now.”
- **Suggest / insist / demand + (that) + subject + V1 or should**: “He insisted that she go.”

If I ___ you, I would accept the offer. (a) am (b) was (c) were (d) will be

(c) were

Second conditional uses “were” for all persons.

If he had worked harder, he ___ the exam. (a) will pass (b) would pass (c) would have passed (d) passed

(c) would have passed

Third conditional: past perfect → would have + V3.

I would rather ___ at home. (a) stay (b) to stay (c) staying (d) stayed

(a) stay

Would rather + base verb.

She is used to ___ early. (a) wake (b) waking (c) woke (d) woken

(b) waking

Be used to + V-ing means accustomed to.

Hardly ___ the office when it started raining. (a) he left (b) had he left (c) he had left (d) did he leave

(b) had he left

Hardly takes inversion with past perfect: had he left ... when.

Shortcuts and tricks

- Identify the if-clause tense and pick the matching main clause.
- “Would” never appears in the if-clause of a conditional.
- Modal + base verb: remove -s, to and -ing.
- “Had I ..., I would have ...” is the third conditional without “if”.

Common mistakes

- “If it will rain”.
- “If I was you” (use were in formal English).
- “She can to swim”, “He must goes”.
- “I wish I would have known”.

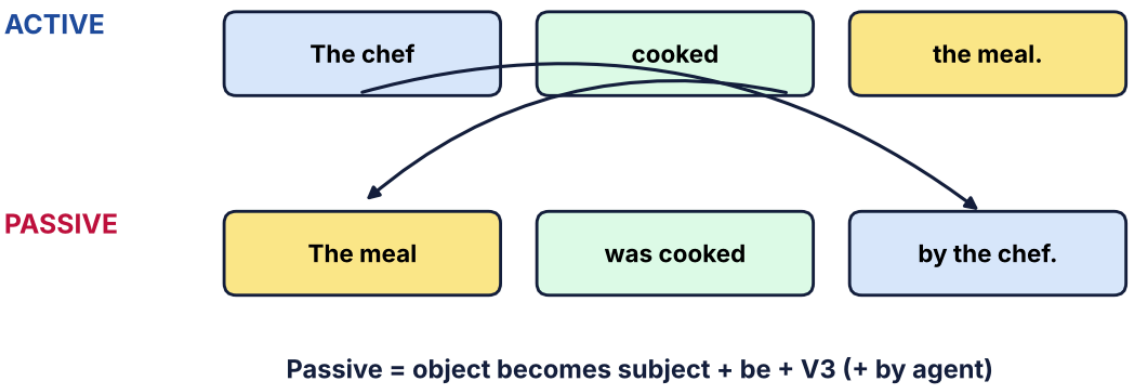
Practice set: Modals and conditionals practice

1. If you heat water to 100°C, it ___. (a) boil (b) boils (c) will boil (d) boiled — Basic
2. She ___ speak three languages. (a) can (b) cans (c) can to (d) is can — Basic
3. If it rains tomorrow, we ___ the picnic. (a) cancel (b) cancelled (c) will cancel (d) would cancel — Basic
4. I wish I ___ the answer. (a) know (b) knew (c) will know (d) have known — Medium
5. If I had left earlier, I ___ the train. (a) would catch (b) will catch (c) would have caught (d) caught — Medium
6. You ___ smoke here. It is prohibited. (a) must not (b) need not (c) may not to (d) ought — Medium
7. ___ I known the truth, I would have told you. (a) If (b) Had (c) Did (d) Have — Advanced
8. He suggested that she ___ a doctor. (a) sees (b) saw (c) see (d) seeing — Advanced

VERBAL ABILITY · GRAMMAR · IMPORTANT

09 Active–Passive Voice and Reported Speech

Voice changes **who is in focus** (doer or receiver). Reported speech retells what someone said. Both topics follow a mechanical pattern: learn the pattern and the answer follows.



Active ↔ passive. The object of the active sentence becomes the subject of the passive.

Tense	Active	Passive
Simple present	She writes a letter.	A letter is written by her.
Present continuous	She is writing a letter.	A letter is being written by her.
Present perfect	She has written a letter.	A letter has been written by her.
Simple past	She wrote a letter.	A letter was written by her.
Past continuous	She was writing a letter.	A letter was being written by her.
Past perfect	She had written a letter.	A letter had been written by her.
Simple future	She will write a letter.	A letter will be written by her.
Modal	She can write a letter.	A letter can be written by her.

Passive voice rules

- Passive = **be (in the right tense) + past participle**.
- Only transitive verbs have a passive form (no passive for “arrive”, “sleep”).
- Questions: “Who wrote it?” → “By whom was it written?”
- Imperative: “Open the door.” → “Let the door be opened.”
- Reported speech: tense steps back; pronouns and time words change (see table).
- Questions in reported speech: **asked + if / whether** (yes/no) or **asked + wh-word**, statement word order (no question inversion): “He asked me where I lived.”
- Commands become to-infinitives: “She told me to sit.” Requests: “asked me to”. Advice: “advised me to”.
- Statements use **said that / told (someone) that**.
- Facts that are always true keep the present: “He said that the sun rises in the east.”

Reported speech: shift one step back

Direct speech	Reported speech
am / is / are	was / were
was / were	had been
has / have done	had done
simple past (did)	had done
will / can / may	would / could / might
now / today / here	then / that day / there
tomorrow / yesterday	the next day / the day before
this / these	that / those

Tense and word shifts for indirect speech.

Change to passive: “They are repairing the road.”

The road is being repaired.

Present continuous: is / are being + V3.

Change to passive: “Who wrote this letter?”

By whom was this letter written?

Simple past passive of a question.

Change to indirect speech: He said, “I am tired.”

He said that he was tired.

Present continuous “am” steps back to “was”; “I” becomes “he”.

Change to indirect speech: She asked, “Where do you live?”

She asked where I lived.

Statement order, past tense, pronoun change.

Change to indirect speech: The teacher said, “Close the door.”

The teacher ordered / told us to close the door.

Imperative becomes a to-infinitive.

Shortcuts and tricks

- Passive: find the object, make it the subject, add the right form of be + V3.
- Reported questions have no “do / does / did” and no question mark.
- If the reporting verb is in the present (“He says”), the tense does not shift.
- Time words move: now → then, today → that day, ago → before.

Common mistakes

- Forgetting “been” in perfect passives (“has written by”).
- Keeping question word order in reported questions.
- Using “that” before a question or command.

Practice set: Voice and speech practice

1. Passive of “She sings a song.” (a) A song sings by her. (b) A song is sung by her. (c) A song was sung by her. (d) A song has been sung by her. — Basic

2. Passive of “They have finished the work.” (a) The work is finished. (b) The work has been finished. (c) The work was finished. (d) The work had been finished. — Basic

3. He said, “I will come.” → He said that he ___. (a) will come (b) would come (c) comes (d) came — Basic

4. She said, “I am cooking.” → She said that she ___. (a) is cooking (b) was cooking (c) has been cooking (d) cooked — Medium

5. He asked, “Are you ready?” → He asked ___. (a) if I was ready (b) are you ready (c) that I was ready (d) if was I ready — Medium

6. Passive of “Someone is watching us.” (a) We are watched. (b) We are being watched. (c) We were watched. (d) We have been watched. — Medium

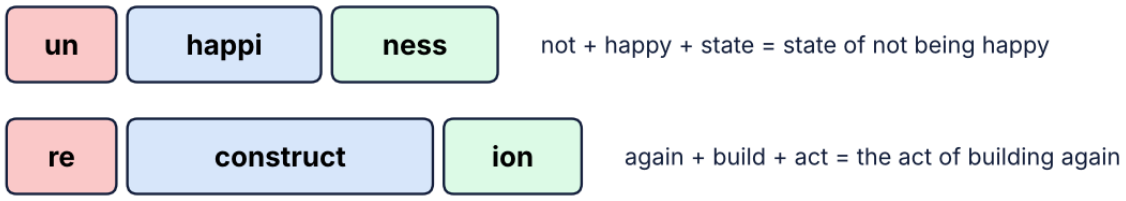
7. Passive of “Open the window.” (a) The window is open. (b) Let the window be opened. (c) The window should open. (d) The window opened. — Advanced

8. The mother said to her son, “Do not play here.” → The mother ___ here. (a) told her son not to play (b) said her son not to play (c) told her son do not play (d) asked her son to not played — Advanced

10 VERBAL ABILITY · VOCABULARY · MUST-DO
Vocabulary and Word Choice

Vocabulary questions ask which word **best fits the meaning and tone** of the sentence. You do not need thousands of rare words; you need **word roots, the most common synonym/antonym groups, confusing pairs and collocations**.

Word anatomy: prefix + root + suffix



Break an unknown word into prefix, root and suffix to guess its meaning.

Prefix	Meaning	Examples
un-, in-, im-, il-, ir-, dis-, non-	not / opposite	unhappy, incorrect, impossible, illegal, irregular, disagree
re-	again	rebuild, review
pre-	before	prepare, predict
post-	after	postpone, postgraduate
mis-	wrongly	misunderstand, misuse
over- / under-	too much / too little	overwork, underestimate
anti- / counter-	against	antibiotic, counterattack
sub- / inter-	under / between	submarine, international

Root	Meaning	Words
bene	good	benefit, benevolent
mal	bad	malfunction, malicious
spect	look	inspect, spectator
port	carry	transport, export
dict	say	predict, dictate
scrib / script	write	describe, manuscript
aud	hear	audible, audience
vis / vid	see	visible, video
chron	time	chronic, synchronise

Synonym groups to know

Meaning	Words (strong → mild where possible)
important	crucial, vital, essential, significant
increase	boost, escalate, expand, grow
decrease	diminish, decline, reduce, dwindle
clear / obvious	evident, apparent, explicit, transparent

dishonest / honest	deceitful, fraudulent / sincere, candid, genuine
calm / angry	serene, tranquil, composed / furious, irate, enraged
brave / afraid	courageous, bold, valiant / timid, fearful, cowardly
rich / poor	affluent, wealthy / needy, destitute, impoverished
happy / sad	joyful, delighted, cheerful / gloomy, miserable, sorrowful

Frequently confused words

Pair	Difference
affect / effect	affect (verb) = influence; effect (noun) = result
accept / except	accept = receive; except = apart from
principal / principle	principal = head, main; principle = rule
stationary / stationery	stationary = not moving; stationery = writing material
complement / compliment	complement = completes; compliment = praise
advice / advise	advice (noun); advise (verb)
lose / loose	lose = fail to keep; loose = not tight
elicit / illicit	elicit = draw out; illicit = illegal
emigrate / immigrate	emigrate = leave a country; immigrate = enter a country
continual / continuous	continual = repeated; continuous = without a break

One-word substitutions and collocations

Phrase	One word
a person who knows everything	omniscient
one who does not believe in God	atheist
a speech made without preparation	extempore / impromptu
one who is present everywhere	omnipresent
a government by the people	democracy
one who walks in sleep	somnambulist
that which cannot be read	illegible
that which cannot be avoided	inevitable
a place where birds are kept	aviary
a book written about someone's life by that person	autobiography

Collocations (words that go together)

- make a decision, make a mistake, make progress; **do** homework, do business, do a favour
- take a risk, take a chance, take advantage of; **give** advice, give a speech, give priority
- heavy rain, strong tea, high temperature, deep sleep, fast food
- meet a deadline, conduct a survey, launch a product, draw a conclusion
- commit a crime, pay attention, run a business, lay the foundation

The speaker's ___ speech kept the audience hooked. (a) monotonous (b) captivating (c) vague (d) tedious

(b) captivating

"Kept hooked" needs a positive word: captivating means attractive and engaging.

Choose the synonym of "scarce". (a) abundant (b) rare (c) common (d) plentiful

(b) rare

Scarce means little available, so rare.

Choose the antonym of "benevolent". (a) kind (b) malevolent (c) generous (d) gentle

(b) malevolent

bene = good, mal = bad.

The new rule will ___ the speed of delivery. (a) effect (b) affect (c) infect (d) defect

(b) affect

A verb is needed (influence): affect.

A speech given without any preparation is called ___. (a) extempore (b) prepared (c) formal (d) oration

(a) extempore

Standard one-word substitution.

Shortcuts and tricks

- Read the sentence for tone first (positive or negative), then pick the word.
- Use roots: mal = bad, bene = good, anti = against, pre = before.
- For synonyms, test by replacing the word in a simple sentence.
- Learn 10 new words every day with one example sentence each.

Common mistakes

- Picking a word that is grammatically right but changes the tone of the sentence.
- Mixing confusing pairs (affect/effect, principal/principle).
- Choosing a rare, "big" word without checking the meaning.

Practice set: Vocabulary practice

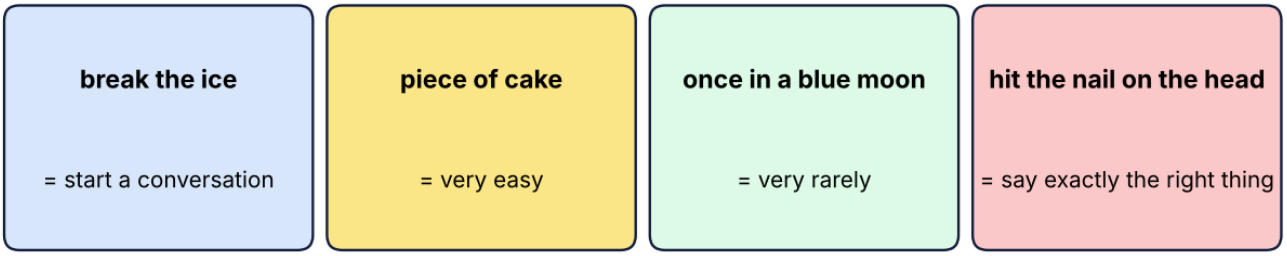
1. Synonym of "huge": (a) tiny (b) enormous (c) average (d) narrow — Basic
2. Antonym of "victory": (a) triumph (b) defeat (c) success (d) win — Basic
3. His ___ attitude made the team uncomfortable. (a) hospitable (b) hostile (c) humble (d) hungry — Basic
4. The ___ of the company is Mr Rao. (a) principal (b) principle (c) prince (d) princely — Medium
5. Synonym of "candid": (a) frank (b) secretive (c) rude (d) modest — Medium
6. One who looks on the bright side: (a) pessimist (b) optimist (c) cynic (d) realist — Medium
7. Antonym of "transparent": (a) clear (b) opaque (c) obvious (d) bright — Advanced
8. The company aims to ___ the cost without reducing quality. (a) diminish (b) diminution (c) dimension (d) diminishing — Advanced

VERBAL ABILITY · VOCABULARY · IMPORTANT

11 Idioms and Phrasal Verbs

An **idiom** is a fixed expression whose meaning is not the sum of its words. A **phrasal verb** is a verb plus a small word (up, down, off, out) that gives a new meaning. Both must be learnt as units; here are the ones that appear most often.

An idiom means something different from its separate words



Idioms are figurative. Never translate them word by word.

Common idioms

Idiom	Meaning
a blessing in disguise	something good that seemed bad at first
bite the bullet	face a hard situation bravely
break the ice	start a conversation
burn the midnight oil	work late at night
call it a day	stop working for now
cost an arm and a leg	be very expensive
cut corners	do something cheaply, skipping steps
get cold feet	become too nervous to do something
go the extra mile	make more effort than expected
hit the nail on the head	be exactly right
in the long run	over a long time
once in a blue moon	very rarely
piece of cake	very easy
spill the beans	reveal a secret
under the weather	slightly ill
the ball is in your court	it is your turn to act

Common phrasal verbs

Phrasal verb	Meaning
call off	cancel
carry out	perform / execute
come across	find by chance
figure out	understand / solve

give up	stop trying
look after	take care of
look into	investigate
look forward to	wait eagerly for
put off	postpone
put up with	tolerate
run out of	have none left
set up	establish
turn down	reject
turn up	arrive / appear
take over	take control
bring up	raise (a child / topic)

How to learn them

- Group by verb: **look** (after, into, up, forward to), **turn** (down, up, on, off), **put** (off, up with, out).
- Write one sentence for each phrase; the sentence builds the memory.
- Check the object: “turn down an offer” (reject) vs “turn the volume down” (reduce).
- Idioms are fixed; do not change a word (“a piece of cakes” is wrong).
- In sentence completion, test each option by replacing the idiom with its plain meaning.

She did not ___ the offer because the salary was low. (a) turn up (b) turn down (c) turn on (d) turn in

(b) turn down

“Reject” is the needed meaning.

The match was ___ due to heavy rain. (a) called off (b) called on (c) called up (d) called in

(a) called off

Called off = cancelled.

He promised to keep it secret but he ___ the beans. (a) spilled (b) dropped (c) threw (d) lost

(a) spilled

Idiom: spill the beans.

We have ___ paper; please order more. (a) run out of (b) run into (c) run over (d) run after

(a) run out of

Run out of = have none left.

Shortcuts and tricks

- Replace the phrase by a simple word to test meaning: called off = cancelled.
- Learn by verb groups.
- For idioms, picture the literal image and the real meaning together.
- Never change the words of an idiom.

Common mistakes

- Using “put on” for “postpone” (the right form is put off).
- Using “look for” (search) for “look after” (care).
- Adding extra words: “break the ices”.

Practice set: Idiom and phrasal verb practice

1. “A piece of cake” means: (a) a dessert (b) something very easy (c) a small portion (d) a gift — Basic

2. The manager asked us to ___ the meeting till Monday. (a) put off (b) put up (c) put on (d) put in — Basic

3. “Burn the midnight oil” means: (a) waste fuel (b) work late into the night (c) be angry (d) sleep early — Basic

4. I came ___ an old photograph while cleaning. (a) across (b) into (c) over (d) upon at — Medium

5. “Under the weather” means: (a) outside in the rain (b) slightly ill (c) very happy (d) lost — Medium

6. We cannot ___ such rude behaviour. (a) put up with (b) put on with (c) put off with (d) put in with — Medium

7. “Cold feet” means: (a) feeling unwell (b) becoming nervous about doing something (c) being unfriendly (d) wearing no shoes — Advanced

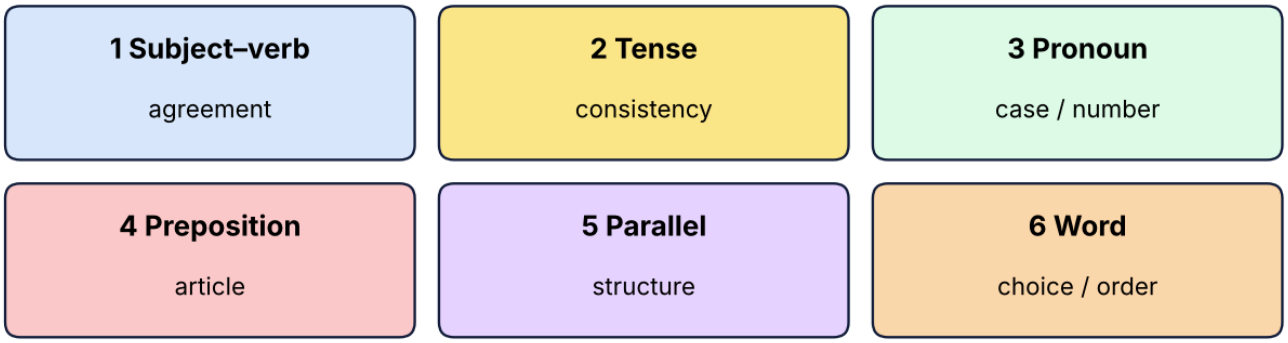
8. The police will ___ the matter. (a) look after (b) look into (c) look for (d) look up to — Advanced

12 Error Spotting and Sentence Structure

VERBAL ABILITY · GRAMMAR · IMPORTANT

Error-spotting asks you to find the part of a sentence that is wrong, or to choose the correct sentence among four. The same ten or so errors repeat. A **fixed scanning order** finds them faster than reading for "sound".

Error-spotting checklist: scan in this order



Check in this order; stop when you find the error.

Frequent structure rules

- **Parallelism**: items in a list must have the same form: "She likes reading, writing and painting" (not "to paint").
- **Misplaced modifier**: place the modifier next to what it modifies. Wrong: "Walking down the road, the tree fell." Right: "While I was walking down the road, a tree fell."
- **Double negative**: "He did not do nothing" is wrong; use "He did nothing."
- **Redundancy**: "return back", "reverse back", "repeat again", "free gift", "advance planning" repeat the same idea.
- **Run-on / comma splice**: two sentences joined only by a comma need a conjunction or full stop.
- **Fragment**: a group of words without a main verb is not a sentence ("Because he was late.").
- **Countable vs uncountable**: "furniture, advice, information, luggage" never take "s" or "a".
- **Plural forms**: "he gave me some advice", not "advices".
- **Comparison**: compare like with like: "The climate of Pune is cooler than that of Delhi."
- **Verb + gerund / infinitive**: enjoy + V-ing, avoid + V-ing, decide + to V, want + to V, suggest + V-ing.

Wrong	Right	Rule
He gave me many advices.	He gave me much advice.	uncountable
She is more taller.	She is taller.	double comparative
I am knowing him.	I know him.	stative verb
He suggested me to go.	He suggested that I go.	suggest + that / V-ing
The team are playing well.	The team is playing well.	collective noun, one unit
Each of the boys have a pen.	Each of the boys has a pen.	each + singular
I prefer tea than coffee.	I prefer tea to coffee.	prefer ... to
Though he was tired, but he worked.	Though he was tired, he worked.	no "but" with though

He is better than me in maths.	He is better than I (am) in maths.	case after than

Spot the error: "One of my friend (a) / is a doctor (b) / and works in Mumbai (c) / No error (d)."

(a)

"One of" is followed by a plural noun: "one of my friends".

Spot the error: "He gave me (a) / several advices (b) / on how to study (c) / No error (d)."

(b)

"Advice" is uncountable: "some advice".

Choose the correct sentence: (a) Neither of the boys are present. (b) Neither of the boys is present. (c) Neither boys is present. (d) Neither of the boy is present.

(b)

"Neither of" + plural noun + singular verb.

Choose the correct sentence: (a) Walking in the park, the sun was bright. (b) While we were walking in the park, the sun was bright. (c) The sun was bright in the park. (d) Walking in the park, we found the sun bright.

(d)

The modifier "Walking in the park" must be next to "we".

Shortcuts and tricks

- Read the sentence in four parts and test each part against the checklist.
- Prepositions and agreement hold most of the errors.
- If a sentence "sounds fine", check for a hidden agreement or tense error.
- If you find nothing after one scan, choose "No error" and move on.

Common mistakes

- Correcting style instead of grammar.
- Choosing "No error" without checking the verb and preposition.
- Missing a pronoun mismatch ("Everyone must bring their pen"—acceptable in modern usage but "his or her" is the exam form).

Practice set: Error spotting practice

1. Choose the correct sentence. (a) He do not like tea. (b) He does not like tea. (c) He does not likes tea. (d) He not likes tea. — Basic
2. Choose the correct sentence. (a) The furniture are new. (b) The furniture is new. (c) The furnitures are new. (d) The furnitures is new. — Basic
3. Choose the correct sentence. (a) I have seen him yesterday. (b) I saw him yesterday. (c) I had seen him yesterday. (d) I am seeing him yesterday. — Basic
4. Choose the correct sentence. (a) She enjoys to swim. (b) She enjoys swimming. (c) She enjoys swim. (d) She enjoy swimming. — Medium

5. Choose the correct sentence. (a) Return back the book. (b) Return the book. (c) Return again the book. (d) Return the book back again. — Medium

6. Choose the correct sentence. (a) He is taller than me. (b) He is more taller than I. (c) He is taller than I am. (d) He is tall than I. — Medium

7. Choose the correct sentence. (a) The climate of Pune is cooler than Delhi. (b) The climate of Pune is cooler than that of Delhi. (c) The climate of Pune is cooler than Delhi's climates. (d) Pune climate is cooler than that Delhi. — Advanced

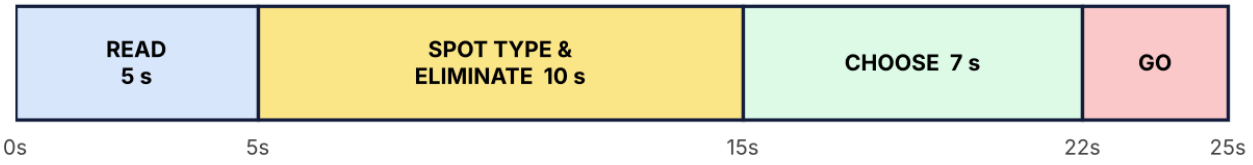
8. Choose the correct sentence. (a) Hardly he had left when it rained. (b) Hardly had he left when it rained. (c) Hardly he left when it rains. (d) Hardly had he left than it rained. — Advanced

VERBAL ABILITY · NEW PATTERN TASK 1 · MUST-DO

13 Sentence Completion: the 25-Second Method

In the new Verbal pattern the first task is **sentence completion: 20 items with about 25 seconds each**. You see a sentence with a blank and four options. There is no time for long thought, so success comes from a **fixed routine** plus the grammar and vocabulary you learned in the earlier chapters.

The 25-second routine for one sentence-completion item



20 items × 25 s = 500 s ≈ 8 min 20 s. Unanswered items score nothing; there is no negative marking, so always choose.

Practise with a timer until the routine runs by itself.

Three kinds of blank

GRAMMAR blank	VOCABULARY blank	LOGIC blank
tense · agreement · article · preposition · pronoun	word meaning · tone · idiom · collocation	connector: but, so, because, although
→ Look at words around the blank	→ Check the mood (+ or –) of the sentence	→ Find the relation between the two ideas

Decide the type of blank in the first 5 seconds. It tells you which rule to apply.

The routine

- **Read once** and look at the two words before and after the blank.
- **Type the blank**: grammar, vocabulary or logic.
- **Eliminate** in this order: verb form → preposition → article/pronoun → connector logic → word meaning.
- **Choose and move**. If two options remain, pick the one that keeps the meaning and sounds natural.
- No negative marking: **never leave an item blank**.
- Do not go back to a skipped item; the timer is per item.
- Mark the questions you got wrong in practice and write the rule in an error log.

Worked examples by blank type

GRAMMAR (tense). By the time we reached the hall, the programme ___. (a) started (b) has started (c) had started (d) starts

(c) had started

“By the time” + past; the earlier action takes past perfect.

GRAMMAR (agreement). The manager, along with his team, ___ attending the meeting. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) be

(b) is

Subject is “manager”.

GRAMMAR (preposition). She is allergic ___ dust. (a) with (b) of (c) to (d) at

(c) to

Fixed phrase: allergic to.

VOCABULARY (tone). The report was so ___ that nobody could understand the conclusion. (a) concise (b) vague (c) accurate (d) clear

(b) vague

The result (nobody could understand) shows a negative word: vague.

VOCABULARY (collocation). We need to ___ a decision before Friday. (a) do (b) make (c) take up (d) give

(b) make

Collocation: make a decision.

LOGIC (connector). He studied day and night; ___, he failed the exam. (a) therefore (b) because (c) however (d) moreover

(c) however

The two ideas contrast: effort versus failure.

LOGIC (cause). The flight was delayed ___ heavy fog. (a) because (b) due to (c) although (d) so

(b) due to

A noun phrase (heavy fog) follows, so “due to”.

Type	First check	Typical traps
Tense	time words (since, yesterday, by the time)	present perfect vs simple past
Agreement	real subject, “of” phrases, along with	nearest noun trap
Preposition	fixed pairs (good at, fond of)	in/on/at, since/for
Article	sound of next word, “the” for known nouns	an university
Vocabulary	positive or negative mood	similar-looking words (affect/effect)
Connector	relation: contrast, cause, result	although ... but

Shortcuts and tricks

- Spend the first 5 seconds on the sentence, not the options.
- If an option makes the sentence ungrammatical, strike it and do not look again.
- Choose the simplest correct option; exam setters rarely hide the answer in a rare word.
- Take timed sets of 10 questions in 4 minutes 10 seconds.

Common mistakes

- Spending 40 seconds on one item.
- Choosing a grammatically right option that changes the meaning.
- Changing a correct answer after a second look without a reason.

Practice set: Timed drill: 25 seconds each

1. She has been working here ___ 2018. (a) for (b) since (c) from (d) in — Basic

2. He asked me ___ I was coming. (a) that (b) whether (c) what (d) which — Basic

3. The children ___ playing in the garden now. (a) is (b) are (c) was (d) be — Basic

4. Despite the heavy rain, the match ___ on time. (a) start (b) started (c) starts (d) starting — Basic

5. She speaks as if she ___ everything. (a) know (b) knew (c) knows (d) has known — Medium

6. The proposal was rejected ___ it was too expensive. (a) although (b) because (c) unless (d) so — Medium

7. The CEO has ___ confidence in his team. (a) complete (b) completion (c) completely (d) completing — Medium

8. The two companies decided to ___ their resources. (a) pool (b) pole (c) poll (d) pull — Medium

9. I would rather ___ at home today. (a) stay (b) to stay (c) staying (d) stayed — Medium

10. Had he worked harder, he ___ the exam. (a) will pass (b) would pass (c) would have passed (d) passed — Advanced

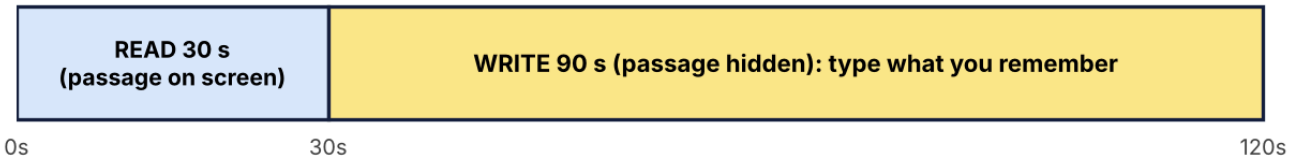
11. Neither the manager nor his assistants ___ aware of the change. (a) is (b) are (c) was (d) has been — Advanced

12. The sudden fall in demand ___ the company to cut jobs. (a) forced (b) forces (c) has forcing (d) forcing — Advanced

14 VERBAL ABILITY · NEW PATTERN TASK 2 · MUST-DO
Passage Recall

Passage Recall is a **memory-plus-typing** task. A short passage stays on screen for about **30 seconds**, then disappears; you have about **90 seconds to type what you remember**. There are **4 such tasks**. Copy the facts, not the exact words: accuracy of key facts and clear writing matter more than word-for-word copying.

One passage-recall task = 120 seconds; 4 tasks in the section



Plan: first 5 s skim · 20 s chunk the facts · then write immediately in the same order

Timeline of one task.

Chunk map: the same passage turned into 3 memory boxes



Group the facts into 3 boxes while reading. Names and numbers go in first.

The method

- **Second 0–5:** skim for the topic: who and what.
- **Second 5–25:** pick out **names, numbers, dates, places** and put them in 3 chunks (who · when/where · what).
- **Second 25–30:** repeat the numbers silently once.
- **Write immediately** when the passage disappears: start with the sentence you remember best.
- Keep the **same order** as the passage; use short sentences.
- Use exact numbers and names. If unsure, skip the detail; do not invent.
- Spend the last 10 seconds fixing spelling and punctuation.

Typing speed (words per minute)	Words you can type in 90 seconds
20 wpm	about 30 words

25 wpm	about 38 words
30 wpm	about 45 words
40 wpm	about 60 words
50 wpm	about 75 words
60 wpm	about 90 words

The practice passages below have **30 to 40 words**. At 30 wpm you can type about 45 words in 90 seconds, so you must **shorten** sentences while keeping every fact. At 40 wpm you can type about 60 words, more than any practice passage here.

Practice passages with key facts and a model recall

Passage 1 (34 words): Riya, a software engineer from Pune, joined Zenith Tech on 3 March. She will work in the cloud team led by Mr Kapoor. Her first project is a billing app due in 6 weeks.

Key facts: Riya · software engineer · Pune · Zenith Tech · 3 March · cloud team · Mr Kapoor · billing app · 6 weeks

Model recall (34 words): Riya, a software engineer from Pune, joined Zenith Tech on 3 March. She will work in the cloud team led by Mr Kapoor. Her first project is a billing app due in 6 weeks.

Passage 2 (31 words): The annual science fair will be held on 14 December at Greenfield School. Over 40 teams from 12 schools will take part. The winning team will receive a trophy and ₹25,000.

Key facts: 14 December · Greenfield School · 40 teams · 12 schools · trophy · ₹25,000

Model recall (27 words): The annual science fair is on 14 December at Greenfield School. Over 40 teams from 12 schools will take part. The winner gets a trophy and ₹25,000.

Passage 3 (30 words): A new metro line between Airport and Central Station opens on 1 July. It has 9 stations and cuts travel time from 55 to 30 minutes. Tickets start at ₹20.

Key facts: Airport · Central Station · 1 July · 9 stations · 55 · 30 minutes · ₹20

Model recall (30 words): A new metro line from Airport to Central Station opens on 1 July. It has 9 stations and cuts travel time from 55 to 30 minutes. Tickets start at ₹20.

Passage 4 (33 words): Dr Mehta's clinic is open Monday to Saturday from 9 am to 1 pm and 5 pm to 8 pm. It is closed on Sundays. Appointments can be booked by phone or app.

Key facts: Monday to Saturday · 9 am to 1 pm · 5 pm to 8 pm · closed on Sundays · phone or app

Model recall (29 words): Dr Mehta's clinic is open Monday to Saturday, 9 am to 1 pm and 5 pm to 8 pm. It is closed on Sundays. Book by phone or app.

How to score yourself

Score	How	Target
Fact score	key facts you wrote correctly ÷ total key facts (list is given for every passage)	70% or more
Accuracy	wrong or invented facts (each costs a fact)	0 invented facts
Spelling	number of spelling slips in your answer	0 to 2
Clarity	complete sentences, same order	all four tasks

The exact marking rule of the actual test is not public. This self-score is a practice tool to show where you lose facts, not an official rubric.

Shortcuts and tricks

- Turn numbers into a small story: “3 March, 6 weeks”.
- Make a picture for names and places.
- Practise on different topics: notices, news, instructions, processes.
- Type for 10 minutes every day; speed gives you time to include more facts.

Common mistakes

- Trying to memorise word for word.
- Writing long sentences and running out of time.
- Adding details that were not in the passage.
- Changing numbers (₹25,000 written as ₹2,500).

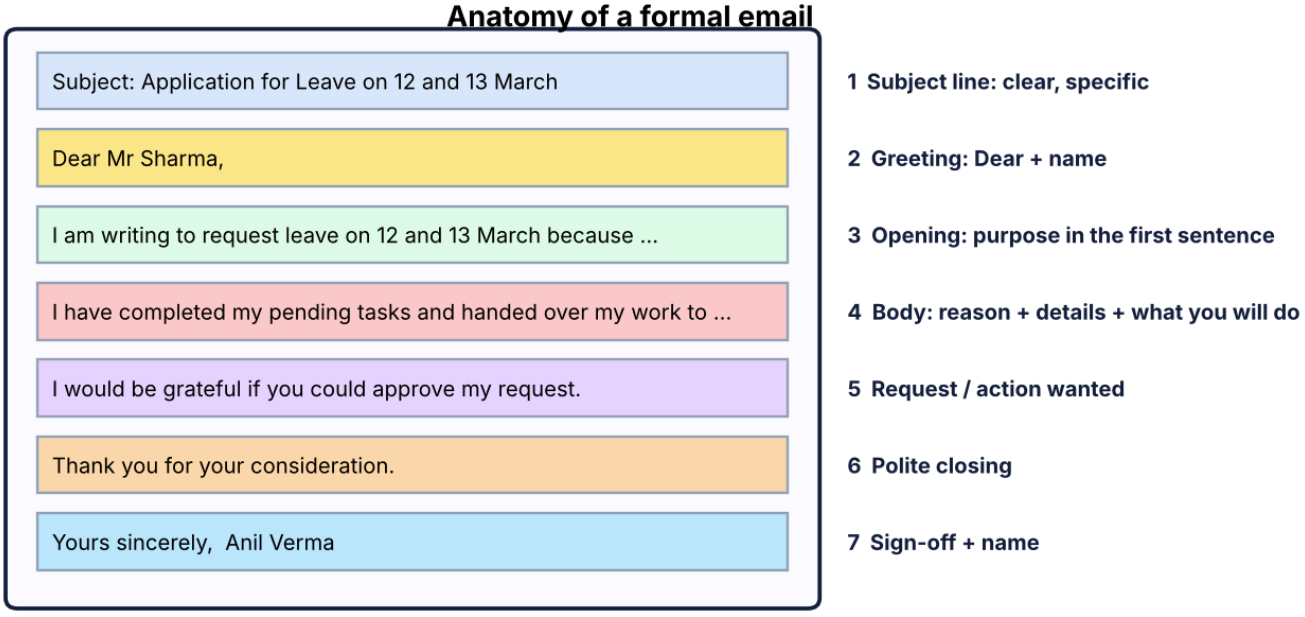
Practice set: Recall drills (read 30 s, write 90 s)

1. Read for 30 s, hide it, write in 90 s: Last quarter, the company's sales rose by 12 percent to ₹48 crore. The growth came mainly from online orders, which doubled. The CEO plans to open two new offices in Chennai and Hyderabad. — Medium
2. Read for 30 s, hide it, write in 90 s: Arjun lost his wallet on the 8:15 bus to Jaipur. A passenger named Sana found it and handed it to the driver. Arjun collected it the next day from the depot, with all ₹3,500 intact. — Medium
3. Read for 30 s, hide it, write in 90 s: The library will remain closed from 20 to 24 January for stock checking. Members may return books in the drop box. Late fees will not be charged for that period. — Medium
4. Read for 30 s, hide it, write in 90 s: The city council has approved a plan to plant 5,000 trees along the ring road by October. Volunteers from 15 colleges will help. Each tree will be tagged with a QR code so citizens can track its growth. — Advanced
5. Read for 30 s, hide it, write in 90 s: Sunrise Foods will open a new plant in Nashik in 2026 with an investment of ₹120 crore. The plant will employ 450 people and produce 30 tonnes of snacks a day. Production is expected to start in the third quarter. — Advanced
6. Read for 30 s, hide it, write in 90 s: Ananya reached the office at 9:40 and found that the server was down. She informed the IT team, who restored it by 11:15. The delay affected three client calls, which were moved to the afternoon. — Advanced

15 VERBAL ABILITY · NEW PATTERN TASK 3 · MUST-DO
Email Writing

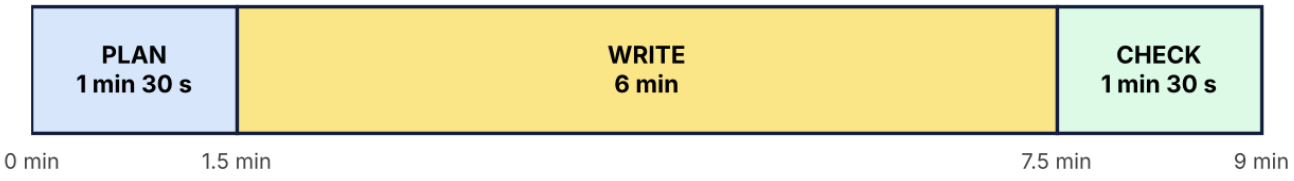
The third task is a **timed email of about 9 minutes**. You get a short work-related situation and must write a clear, polite and well-organised email. A good email has **a purpose in the first sentence**, enough detail to act on, correct grammar and a courteous close. Prepare **templates** now so that on the day only the details change.

Anatomy of a formal email



Seven parts of a formal email. Follow this order every time.

Suggested split of the 9-minute email task



This split is our advice, not an official rule.

Use the first minute and a half to plan: who, why, what you want, by when.

What a good email contains

- **Subject line** (5–8 words) that states the purpose.
- **Greeting**: Dear Mr/Ms + surname, or Dear Team / Dear Sir or Madam when the name is unknown.
- **Purpose in sentence 1**: "I am writing to …".
- **Body**: the reason, the key facts (dates, numbers, names), and what you have done or will do.
- **Clear request or next step** with a time: "by Friday".
- **Polite closing** and sign-off: Yours sincerely (name known), Yours faithfully (name unknown), Regards / Best regards (neutral).
- **Length**: roughly 80 to 150 words; short paragraphs.
- Formal tone: no slang, no abbreviations (don't, ASAP), no emoji, no capital-letter shouting.

Instead of	Write	Why
I want leave	I would like to request leave	polite
Do it fast	Kindly complete it at the earliest	polite request
You didn't reply	I have not yet received a reply	neutral, not blaming
Sorry for the problem	I apologise for the inconvenience caused	formal
Tell me	Please let me know / Kindly confirm	polite request
asap	at the earliest / by Friday	specific

Phrase bank

Purpose	Useful phrases
Opening	I am writing to … · I am writing regarding … · With reference to …
Request	Could you please … · I would be grateful if you could … · Kindly …
Apology	I sincerely apologise for … · I regret the delay · Please accept my apologies
Complaint	I am disappointed to inform you … · I request an immediate resolution
Information	Please find attached … · I am pleased to inform you that …
Follow-up	I am following up on … · As discussed in today's meeting …
Closing	Thank you for your time. · I look forward to your reply. · Please let me know if you need any further information.

Eight model emails

Each body below is between 50 and 85 words (counted by code) so it can be typed in the available time. Change the facts, keep the structure.

Request for leave

Subject: Application for Leave on 12 and 13 March
Dear Mr Sharma,

I am writing to request leave on 12 and 13 March because I have to attend a family function in my hometown. I have completed my pending tasks and handed over the ongoing work to my colleague, Neha Rao, who will manage it in my absence. I will remain available by phone for any urgent matter. I would be grateful if you could approve my request.

Thank you for your consideration.
Yours sincerely,
Anil Verma

Body: 66 words

Complaint about a service

Subject: Complaint Regarding Delayed Delivery of Order 4821
Dear Customer Support Team,

I placed order number 4821 on 3 June, and it was promised for delivery within three days. It is now ten days later and the package has not arrived. I have contacted your helpline twice, but the problem is still unresolved. Please arrange delivery within two working days or issue a full refund. I would appreciate a written update on the status of my order.

I look forward to your prompt reply.
Regards,
Priya Nair

Body: 65 words

Follow-up after a meeting

Subject: Follow-up: Action Items from Today’s Project Meeting
Dear Team,

Thank you for attending today’s meeting. I would like to confirm the action items we agreed on. Rahul will share the revised design by Wednesday, Meena will complete testing by Friday, and I will update the client on Monday. Please let me know if I have missed anything or if any deadline needs to change.

Thank you for your support.
Best regards,
Sanjay Iyer

Body: 55 words

Request for information

Subject: Request for Details of the Data Analytics Course
Dear Admissions Team,

I am a final-year engineering student and I am interested in your six-month Data Analytics course. Could you please share the course fee, the schedule of classes and the eligibility criteria? I would also like to know whether a certificate is provided on completion. A brief reply with these details will help me decide before the registration date.

Thank you for your time.
Sincerely,
Kavya Menon

Body: 58 words

Apology for a delay

Subject: Apology for Delay in Submitting the Quarterly Report
Dear Ms Gupta,

I apologise for the delay in submitting the quarterly report, which was due on Monday. The delay was caused by a data issue that required extra verification. I have now completed the report and attached it to this email. I will make sure that I share my work earlier in future so that such delays do not occur again.

Thank you for your understanding.
Yours sincerely,
Rohan Das

Body: 59 words

Introduction and job application

Subject: Application for the Software Trainee Position
Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Software Trainee position advertised on your website. I have recently completed my B.Tech in Computer Science and have built two projects in Java and SQL. I am a quick learner and enjoy teamwork. I have attached my resume for your review and would welcome the chance to discuss my application.

Thank you for considering my application.
Yours faithfully,
Meera Joshi

Body: 57 words

Reminder / payment follow-up

Subject: Reminder: Payment of Invoice 1057 Due on 20 July
Dear Mr Khan,

This is a gentle reminder that the payment for invoice 1057, amounting to ₹45,000, is due on 20 July. I have attached a copy of the invoice for your convenience. If the payment has already been made, please ignore this message and accept my thanks. Kindly let me know if you need any clarification.

Thank you for your cooperation.
Kind regards,
Vikram Patel

Body: 54 words

Thank-you and feedback

Subject: Thank You for the Training Session
Dear Mr Singh,

Thank you for conducting the training session on time management yesterday. The practical examples were very useful, and the checklist you shared has already helped me plan my week better. I would also like to suggest that a follow-up session be organised for the whole team. Please accept my sincere thanks for your effort.

Warm regards,
Divya Rao

Body: 54 words

Quick self-check (30 seconds)

Check	Yes / No
Subject line present and specific	
Greeting and sign-off with name	
Purpose stated in the first sentence	
Every fact from the question used (names, dates, numbers)	
One clear request or next step	
Polite and formal tone	
No spelling or punctuation errors	

Shortcuts and tricks

- Keep ready one template per situation: request, complaint, apology, follow-up, information, application.
- Use the facts given in the question; do not invent names, amounts or dates.
- Write short sentences; long sentences cause errors.
- If time runs low, finish with a one-line polite closing and your name.
- Type 10 minutes a day: speed gives you room to check.

Common mistakes

- Starting with a long background before stating the purpose.
- Using informal words (hi, thanks a lot, gonna).
- Forgetting the subject line or the sign-off.
- Writing one huge paragraph.
- Using the wrong ending ("Yours faithfully" with a named person).

Practice set: Email practice prompts (9 minutes each)

1.	Write to your manager requesting two days of leave next week for a family event; say who will cover your work.	Basic
2.	Write to a vendor about a late delivery of office chairs ordered on 5 May; ask for delivery in three days.	Basic
3.	Write to your team after a meeting to confirm three action items with deadlines.	Medium
4.	Write to a college asking for the fee structure and last date of a certificate course.	Medium
5.	Apologise to a client for missing a deadline and give a new date.	Medium
6.	Write to HR to apply for an internship and attach your resume.	Advanced
7.	Politely remind a client that an invoice of ₹30,000 is overdue by one week.	Advanced

VERBAL ABILITY · FINAL CHAPTER

16 Typing, Strategy, Formula Sheet and Mini Test

Two of the three new-pattern tasks (passage recall and email) need **fast, accurate typing**. This chapter gives a typing routine, a plan for the whole section, a one-page rules sheet, and a **20-question mini test** in the style of Task 1.

Typing speed and accuracy

Formulas

- **Words per minute (wpm)** = (characters typed ÷ 5) ÷ minutes. Example: 600 characters in 3 minutes = (600 ÷ 5) ÷ 3 = **40 wpm**.
- **Accuracy %** = correct characters ÷ total characters × 100.
- Aim: 30 wpm with 95% accuracy as the minimum; 40 wpm is comfortable.
- Daily practice: 5 minutes of copying a passage + 5 minutes of writing an email from memory.
- Posture: wrists straight, eyes on the screen, use all ten fingers.

Plan for the whole Verbal section

Task	Count and time	What to do
1. Sentence completion	20 items, ~25 s each (~8 min 20 s)	Routine: read, type the blank, eliminate, choose. Never leave blank.
2. Passage recall	4 tasks, 30 s read + 90 s write each (8 min)	Chunk facts, write fast, keep numbers exact.
3. Email writing	1 task, about 9 minutes	Plan 1.5 min, write 6 min, check 1.5 min.
Total	about 26 minutes	Practise each task separately, then together.

The timings above follow the new Verbal pattern as described in this series; check the latest TCS notice for any change before the test.

One-page rules sheet

Topic	Remember
Tenses	since + point, for + period; by the time → past perfect; if + present → will
Agreement	each / every / neither + singular; along with ignored; nearer subject for either-or
Articles	a/an by sound; the with superlatives and known nouns; few = almost none, a few = some
Prepositions	in-on-at funnel; since/for; between/among; fixed pairs (fond of, good at)
Pronouns	after prepositions use me/him; than I (am); who/whom/whose
Comparison	than with comparatives; the + superlative; to after senior/junior/prefer
Conditionals	zero/first/second/third; if I were; had + V3 inversion
Voice and speech	be + V3; tense steps back; questions lose inversion
Vocabulary	roots (bene, mal, spect); tone; confusing pairs
Idioms	learn by verb group; replace with plain meaning
Error spotting	agreement → tense → pronoun → preposition → parallel → word choice
Recall	who, when/where, what; exact numbers; same order

Email	subject, greeting, purpose, body, request, closing, sign-off

Five-week plan

Week	Focus
1	Tenses, agreement, articles, prepositions (10 questions a day)
2	Pronouns, conjunctions, comparison, conditionals, voice and speech
3	Vocabulary, idioms, error spotting; start passage recall (2 a day)
4	Timed sentence-completion sets; email templates (1 a day)
5	Full section practice: 20 + 4 + 1 in one sitting; review mistakes

Mini test: Sentence Completion (20 items, 25 seconds each)

Mixed mini test

1. Neither the teacher nor the students ___ present yesterday. (a) was (b) were (c) is (d) has been
2. She has lived in Nagpur ___ five years. (a) since (b) for (c) from (d) in
3. The committee ___ its decision yesterday. (a) announced (b) announce (c) announcing (d) have announced
4. He is ___ honest man. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) no article
5. If I ___ rich, I would travel the world. (a) am (b) was (c) were (d) will be
6. The report must be submitted ___ Monday at the latest. (a) in (b) at (c) by (d) since
7. The manager praised the team ___ their hard work. (a) for (b) of (c) with (d) at
8. Choose the synonym of “abundant”. (a) scarce (b) plentiful (c) weak (d) hidden
9. Choose the antonym of “expand”. (a) grow (b) shrink (c) increase (d) spread
10. He ___ the offer because the pay was low. (a) turned up (b) turned down (c) turned on (d) turned in
11. Hardly had she reached the station ___ the train left. (a) than (b) when (c) then (d) that
12. The new policy will ___ all employees. (a) effect (b) affect (c) infect (d) defect
13. This is the ___ of all the options. (a) good (b) better (c) best (d) well
14. He suggested that the meeting ___ postponed. (a) is (b) be (c) was (d) being
15. The audience ___ the speaker with a long applause. (a) welcomed (b) welcoming (c) welcome to (d) has welcome
16. She is fond ___ classical music. (a) at (b) of (c) with (d) to
17. The project was completed ahead of schedule; ___, the client was pleased. (a) however (b) therefore (c) although (d) unless
18. Passive of “They are building a bridge.” (a) A bridge is built. (b) A bridge is being built. (c) A bridge was built. (d) A bridge has been built.
19. She said, “I have finished.” → She said that she ___. (a) has finished (b) had finished (c) finished (d) was finished
20. One who knows everything is called ___. (a) omnipresent (b) omniscient (c) optimist (d) orator

Shortcuts and tricks

- Take the mini test with a timer: 8 minutes 20 seconds total.
- Score: 18+ excellent, 14–17 good, below 14 revise the grammar chapters.
- Write each wrong answer in the error log with the rule.

Answer key

Answers to every practice set and to the mini test. B = Basic, M = Medium, A = Advanced.

1. Parts of speech

1. (b) beautifully (B)
2. (c) learning (B)
3. (b) completion (M)
4. (b) serious (M)
5. (b) quickly (M)
6. (b) He is good at maths. (A)
7. (a) clear (A)

2. Tenses

1. (b) goes (B)
2. (c) are watching (B)
3. (c) finished (B)
4. (c) have lived (M)
5. (c) had left (M)
6. (a) work (M)
7. (c) had had (A)
8. (c) will have worked (A)

3. Agreement

1. (b) has received (B)
2. (b) is (B)
3. (c) are (M)
4. (a) is (acting as one unit) (M)
5. (b) is (M)
6. (b) is (A)
7. (c) were (A)

4. Articles

1. (a) a (B)
2. (b) an (B)
3. (c) The (B)
4. (c) little (M)
5. (d) no article (M)
6. (c) the (M)
7. (b) fewer (A)
8. (d) — (no article: few = almost none) (A)

5. Prepositions

1. (b) of (B)
2. (c) on (B)
3. (b) on (B)
4. (b) on (M)
5. (c) no preposition: “discussed the project” (M)
6. (b) for (M)
7. (a) to / for (A)
8. (b) within (A)

6. Pronouns

1. (b) I (B)
2. (c) mine (B)
3. (b) Although (B)
4. (c) whose (M)
5. (b) because (M)
6. (b) Despite (M)
7. (b) than (A)
8. (b) its (A)

7. Comparison

1. (b) cleverer (B)
2. (c) highest (B)
3. (c) more (B)
4. (b) to (M)
5. (b) better (M)
6. (a) smarter (M)
7. (c) to (A)
8. (b) too (A)

8. Conditionals

1. (b) boils (B)
2. (a) can (B)
3. (c) will cancel (B)
4. (b) knew (M)
5. (c) would have caught (M)
6. (a) must not (M)
7. (b) Had (A)
8. (c) see (A)

9. Voice and speech

1. (b) A song is sung by her. (B)
2. (b) The work has been finished. (B)
3. (b) would come (B)
4. (b) was cooking (M)
5. (a) if I was ready (M)
6. (b) We are being watched. (M)
7. (b) Let the window be opened. (A)
8. (a) told her son not to play (A)

10. Vocabulary

1. (b) enormous (B)
2. (b) defeat (B)
3. (b) hostile (B)
4. (a) principal (M)
5. (a) frank (M)
6. (b) optimist (M)
7. (b) opaque (A)
8. (a) diminish (A)

11. Idioms

1. (b) something very easy (B)
2. (a) put off (B)
3. (b) work late into the night (B)
4. (a) across (M)
5. (b) slightly ill (M)
6. (a) put up with (M)
7. (b) becoming nervous about doing something (A)
8. (b) look into (A)

12. Error spotting

1. (b) (B)
2. (b) (B)
3. (b) (B)
4. (b) (M)
5. (b) (M)
6. (c) (M)
7. (b) (A)
8. (b) (A)

13. Sentence completion

1. (b) since (B)
2. (b) whether (B)
3. (b) are (B)
4. (b) started (B)
5. (b) knew (M)
6. (b) because (M)
7. (a) complete (M)
8. (a) pool (M)
9. (a) stay (M)
10. (c) would have passed (A)
11. (b) are (A)
12. (a) forced (A)

14. Passage recall

1. Key facts: 12 percent · ₹48 crore · online orders · doubled · two new offices · Chennai · Hyderabad (M)
2. Key facts: Arjun · wallet · 8:15 bus · Jaipur · Sana · driver · next day · depot · ₹3,500 (M)
3. Key facts: 20 to 24 January · stock checking · drop box · Late fees will not be charged (M)
4. Key facts: 5,000 trees · ring road · October · 15 colleges · QR code (A)
5. Key facts: Nashik · 2026 · ₹120 crore · 450 people · 30 tonnes · third quarter (A)
6. Key facts: Ananya · 9:40 · server was down · IT team · 11:15 · three client calls · afternoon (A)

15. Email writing

1. Use the leave template (B)
2. Use the complaint template (B)
3. Use the follow-up template (M)
4. Use the information template (M)
5. Use the apology template (M)
6. Use the application template (A)
7. Use the reminder template (A)

Mini test (20 items)

1. (b) were (M)
2. (b) for (M)
3. (a) announced (M)
4. (b) an (M)
5. (c) were (M)
6. (c) by (M)
7. (a) for (M)
8. (b) plentiful (M)
9. (b) shrink (M)
10. (b) turned down (M)
11. (b) when (M)
12. (b) affect (M)
13. (c) best (M)
14. (b) be (M)
15. (a) welcomed (M)
16. (b) of (M)
17. (b) therefore (M)
18. (b) A bridge is being built. (M)
19. (b) had finished (M)
20. (b) omniscient (M)